

This text will be used in recruitment emails directed toward prospective questionnaire respondents.

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Dear [recipient's name],

I am Zachary Batist, a Postdoctoral Researcher working with the Covid-19 Immunity Task Force Databank conducting a study on the collaborative, administrative and operational aspects of health data sharing. I received your contact information from the CITF Databank's roster of key study personnel.

Specifically, I am seeking to understand challenges associated with the administrative and technical apparatus that scaffold the CITF Databank's operations, from multiple stakeholder perspectives, and I invite you to participate in a brief survey about your experiences working with the CITF Databank.

I understand that it has been some time since you engaged with the CITF Databank in a productive capacity, but your detailed responses will be invaluable for helping us trace common issues and challenges that data contributors face, and will support development of institutional policy frameworks and operational workflows that support more effective data sharing that serve researchers' needs.

We also strongly encourage you to share this questionnaire with any other individuals who were involved in operations dealing with the CITF Databank, including data managers, research associates, co-principal investigators, and/or technical or administrative support staff. We seek to understand the perspectives of people working in multiple roles, and we welcome responses deriving from multiple perspectives.

The short questionnaire should take around 30 minutes to complete. It will ask participants about their professional backgrounds, their roles in the respective projects, and their experiences while engaging with the CITF Databank. To be clear, the goal is not to judge anyone's performance in any way, but rather to ascertain the nature of various positive and negative experiences, in order to improve future data sharing initiatives. No personal identifying information will be collected.

Your participation in this study is entirely voluntary. Declining to participate, or withdrawing at any point, will have no bearing on your standing with, or any past or future collaboration with, the CITF Databank.

The study has been approved by McGill University's REB (file #26-08-029). I'd be happy to meet to discuss any questions or concerns you might have before deciding whether you want to participate.

In any case, I look forward to hearing back from you soon,

Zachary Batist, PhD

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Postdoctoral Researcher | CITF Databank

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